

IT move-in and business-handover checklist

What to order, test and take control of when you move into a new office or buy a business.

Part 1: Moving into a new space

As soon as you pick the space

- ☐ Ask the landlord which internet providers already serve the building. Do not assume yours does.
- ☐ Order internet the day you sign. Business installs often take several weeks, and longer if the building needs new wiring or construction. Get the install date in writing.
- ☐ Plan a fallback, such as a cellular (4G/5G) internet box, in case the date slips.
- ☐ Phones: to keep your numbers, start the transfer ("port") early. Have a recent bill and the account holder's name ready. Do not cancel the old service until the port is finished.

Before furniture arrives

- ☐ Cabling: mark on a floor plan where desks, printers, Wi-Fi units, cameras and door readers go. Add spare network jacks now. Adding them later costs more.
- ☐ Ask who may run cable in the building and who controls the telecom closet.
- ☐ Choose a lockable, cool spot with power for the network equipment.
- ☐ Wi-Fi: business-grade, ceiling-mounted units placed from the floor plan. Keep guest Wi-Fi separate from the business network.
- ☐ Tell your printer or copier dealer the move date. Network and scan-to-email settings usually need redoing.

Before opening day

- ☐ Test internet speed, every jack, Wi-Fi in every room, calls in and out, printing, scanning, card readers, cameras and door access.
- ☐ Ask your phone provider to update the 911 address for internet-based (VoIP) phones.

Part 2: Buying a business

Get these at closing. For each one: the login, full admin rights, and the recovery email and phone number changed to yours. Ask your attorney to list them in the purchase agreement.

- ☐ Domain name registration. Who is the registered owner? It should be the company, not the seller personally, an ex-employee or a web designer.
- ☐ DNS (where the domain's records are managed)
- ☐ Email admin account (Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace)
- ☐ Website hosting and the website admin login
- ☐ Social media accounts and the Google Business Profile
- ☐ Software licenses and subscriptions, and which card pays for each
- ☐ Password manager, or a complete list of logins
- ☐ Backups: where they are, who can sign in, when a restore was last tested
- ☐ Security cameras, alarm and door-access admin
- ☐ Phone numbers, and whose name is on the carrier account
- ☐ Vendor contracts: internet, phones, copier lease, IT, software. End dates? Auto-renewal? Transferable?

Day one

- ☐ Change every admin password, then every shared password. Turn on multi-factor sign-in (MFA) with your own phone.
- ☐ Remove the ex-owner's and ex-staff's sign-ins, email forwarding, remote-access tools, door fobs and alarm codes.
- ☐ Change the Wi-Fi password and the router or firewall admin password.
- ☐ Move renewals to your card so the domain and email never lapse.

Questions? Supreme IT Experts - (610) 500-9209 - supremeitexperts.com - Free 30-minute IT + AI Checkup: supremeitexperts.com/checkup

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